

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from an online article about technology:

Warning signs you are addicted to technology

Today, it is virtually impossible to live without the aid of some form of technology (like smartphones, the internet, computers etc.). This makes it extremely difficult to escape from technology. As work, school and play can all involve computers and the internet, normal computer usage levels become more intense each year. In 2013, the average student in America aged 8-18 spent more than 7.5 hours a day involved with non-school-related technology!

Below are some signs that might indicate that you are addicted to technology:

1. Increasing your time spent daily on computer and internet activities that are not related to work or school.
2. Feeling very anxious or distressed when separated from technology (e.g. not being able to check emails, surf the internet, send mobile text messages etc.).
3. Multi-tasking by using multiple forms of technology at one time (e.g. playing computer games while watching TV and listening to music etc.), which could lead to a lack of concentration.
4. Losing confidence and interest in the real world while choosing the comfort of a virtual world, thus sacrificing time spent with friends and family, or even skipping school.

We certainly can't live without technology today. The key is finding the balance between our constant need to engage with technology without becoming digital slaves.

Your group wants to give a class presentation about addiction to technology. Discuss with your group what to include in your presentation. You may want to talk about:

- why some Hong Kong teenagers are addicted to technology
- possible signs of being addicted to technology
- any tips or advice for overcoming technology addiction
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. What do you use the computer for?
2. Should parents control the amount of time children spend on the computer?
3. What would you do if you could not use the computer for a week?
4. Which is worse – having no computer or no mobile phone?
5. If you could only use the computer for one hour a day, what would you do?
6. Is spending seven and a half hours a day on the computer unhealthy?
7. In your opinion, is being addicted to technology a serious problem?
8. Who is to blame for the addiction to technology?